

ELSEWHERE...

- James Callaghan became prime minister of the United Kingdom (below).



He promised a reformist government to the people.

- The US Supreme Court ruled that the death penalty was not inherently cruel and was a constitutionally acceptable form of punishment.
- Jimmy Carter defeated Gerald Ford in the US presidential elections, becoming the first candidate from deep south to win since the Civil War.

153

metre was the length of the world's thickest coal seam discovered in Bihar.

Rs 440 crore

was the estimated rural indebtedness in Andhra Pradesh. The average liability of a rural family was Rs 663.09.

TOTAL CONTROL:
Police cracking
down on protesters



MASTER STROKES

Sunil Gavaskar, "the little master", scored 102 runs, and G.R. Viswanath cobbled up a bold 112, leading the Indian cricket team to a historic win against the West Indies at Port of Spain in April. With a fantastic 85 runs to his credit, Mohinder Amarnath, who batted for well over 400 minutes, was not far behind. India, chasing the then highest-ever fourth innings target of 403, won by six wickets.

"SHE LISTENED TO ME EVEN WHEN I WAS FIVE YEARS OLD."

Sanjay Gandhi

So said Sanjay Gandhi about the prime minister in an interview to a magazine called *Surge*. Surrounded by his coterie of Naveen Chawla, P.S. Bhinder, Rukhsana Sultana and Ambika Soni, Sanjay, who held no office, but was regarded as the prime minister's adviser, launched the controversial family planning programme amidst allegations of coercion. His five-point programme of family planning, tree planting, ban on dowry, removal of illiteracy and slum clearance turned India into what *Times* columnist Bernard Levin called a tin-pot dictatorship, transforming the country into a "fully authoritarian regime under its seedy dictator, Mrs Indira Gandhi".

